

INTAKE-ARBITER -- FREE-COOLING DECISION REPORT

Data centres over-cool, continuously, because nobody can promise them the hours ahead. A chiller plant needs hours of notice to change mode, and a thermometer only ever reports NOW -- so the mechanical chillers keep running through hours that outside air could have cooled for free. FortyGuard closes that gap with heat intelligence 2 m above the ground, the height a ground-mounted condenser actually breathes. This agent turns that forecast into an hour-by-hour schedule carrying a calibrated safety bound.

THE SITE

Location Digital Realty DFW36, TX -- station KDAL, America/Chicago
Building OSM 465032487
Facade gap Digital Realty DFW36 not applicable -- one building, no second facade
Weather record 43,803 real hourly records from KDAL
Plume physics NOT MODELLED. No other tagged data centre lies inside the solver's validated range, so there is no neighbour intake for a plume to arrive at: the quantity does not exist here rather than being unmeasured. This is a statement about the model's domain, not a claim that recirculation here is zero. A building's own exhaust re-entering its own intake is not modelled at any site in this project.

FortyGuard data: weather and geometry are this site's own; the four measured FortyGuard level offsets and the N-26 coverage record are Ashburn's, because only Ashburn has forecast/outcome day pairs. Quote the hours for this site; quote the coverage for Ashburn.

THIS REPORT IS A SNAPSHOT, NOT THE LIVE PAGE

The interface recomputes the decision for whatever configuration a reader selects. This file was generated at build time for the ONE configuration named below, chosen because it is the configuration in which this site's agent does the most while still changing mode at least once. If the numbers on screen differ from the numbers here, the configuration differs -- compare the two lists before concluding anything else.

Day 2022-01-01 (crossing)
Plant limit 18.0 C
Notice required 3 h
Forecast skill 0.50 relative to persistence
Level anchor sensor
Condenser bank longest facade
Switch budget 2 mode changes per day
Minimum dwell 3 h
Max dew point gate off

WHAT THE AGENT DID ON THIS DAY

The agent ran free cooling for 10 of 24 hours with 1 mode change. That is 9 more than the reactive incumbent, at 0 unsafe hours against its 1. The incumbent had to break its own switch budget 1 time to stay safe; the agent never did. 4 hours were safe but still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them.

Agent 10 of 24 hours free cooling, 1 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
Incumbent 1 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 1 unsafe hour(s)
the incumbent broke its own switch budget 1 time(s) to stay safe
4 hour(s) passed every gate and still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them

EVERY HOUR, AND THE REASON FOR IT

hh	mode	safe	binding	bound	limit	actual	margin
00	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.055	18.0	18.330	0.688

01	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.330	18.0	18.330	0.877
02	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.055	18.0	17.780	0.801
03	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.055	18.0	17.780	0.723
04	mechanical	yes	switch budget	17.775	18.0	17.220	0.664
05	mechanical	yes	switch budget	17.225	18.0	16.670	0.589
06	mechanical	yes	switch budget	17.500	18.0	16.670	0.734
07	mechanical	yes	switch budget	17.500	18.0	16.670	0.622
08	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.610	18.0	16.670	1.226
09	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	20.000	18.0	17.220	1.540
10	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.670	18.0	19.440	1.544
11	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	22.225	18.0	20.560	1.497
12	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	22.775	18.0	21.670	1.392
13	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	23.885	18.0	22.780	1.157
14	FREE	yes	-	17.780	18.0	10.560	0.979
15	FREE	yes	-	15.555	18.0	6.110	0.851
16	FREE	yes	-	14.165	18.0	3.330	0.797
17	FREE	yes	-	6.945	18.0	2.220	0.826
18	FREE	yes	-	3.335	18.0	0.560	0.805
19	FREE	yes	-	1.085	18.0	-0.610	0.947
20	FREE	yes	-	-0.030	18.0	-1.720	1.087
21	FREE	yes	-	-1.390	18.0	-2.780	1.034
22	FREE	yes	-	-2.525	18.0	-3.890	0.894
23	FREE	yes	-	-3.635	18.0	-5.000	0.765

bound = the agent's 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air, forecast plus margin

actual = what the intake temperature turned out to be, from the station record

margin = group-conditional forecast error for that hour of day, plus plume spread

THE REASONING, HOUR BY HOUR

00:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.055 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.055 C. It would take a limit 0.055 C higher, or a bound 0.055 C tighter, to change this hour.

01:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.330 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.330 C. It would take a limit 0.330 C higher, or a bound 0.330 C tighter, to change this hour.

02:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.055 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.055 C. It would take a limit 0.055 C higher, or a bound 0.055 C tighter, to change this hour.

03:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.055 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.055 C. It would take a limit 0.055 C higher, or a bound 0.055 C tighter, to change this hour.

04:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 17.775 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

05:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 17.225 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is

also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

06:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 17.500 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

07:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 17.500 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

08:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.610 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.610 C. It would take a limit 0.610 C higher, or a bound 0.610 C tighter, to change this hour.

09:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 20.000 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 2.000 C. It would take a limit 2.000 C higher, or a bound 2.000 C tighter, to change this hour.

10:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.670 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.670 C. It would take a limit 3.670 C higher, or a bound 3.670 C tighter, to change this hour.

11:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 22.225 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 4.225 C. It would take a limit 4.225 C higher, or a bound 4.225 C tighter, to change this hour.

12:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 22.775 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 4.775 C. It would take a limit 4.775 C higher, or a bound 4.775 C tighter, to change this hour.

13:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 23.885 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 5.885 C. It would take a limit 5.885 C higher, or a bound 5.885 C tighter, to change this hour.

14:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 17.780 C, which is 0.220 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.979 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.979 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

15:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 15.555 C, which is 2.445 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.851 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.851 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

16:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 14.165 C, which is 3.835 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.797 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.797 C of group-conditional forecast error for

this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

17:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 6.945 C, which is 11.055 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.826 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.826 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

18:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 3.335 C, which is 14.665 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.805 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.805 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

19:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 1.085 C, which is 16.915 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.947 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.947 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

20:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is -0.030 C, which is 18.030 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.086 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.086 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

21:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is -1.390 C, which is 19.390 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.034 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.034 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

22:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is -2.525 C, which is 20.525 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.894 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.894 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

23:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is -3.635 C, which is 21.635 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.765 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.765 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

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